Q. WHO DO YOU THINK IS INDIA'S NO. 1 FEMALE CRICKETER?



2 **HARMANPREET KAUR**
14.2 [11.1]



3 **DEEPTI SHARMA**
12.5 [6.2]



4 **SHAFALI VERMA**
6.3 [16.3]



5 **JEMIMAH RODRIGUES**
5.8 [2.7]

1 **SMRITI MANDHANA**
33.2
[36.6]



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Rest, others & don't know/ can't say; all figures in %; Aug. '26 figures in red, Jan. '26 in [ ]

Q. 3. Who do you think is India's No. 1 male sportsperson?

1 **NEERAJ CHOPRA** *(Javelin)*
25.1 [20.9]



AP

2 **SUNIL CHHETRI** *(Football)*
17.6 [17.1]





3 **HARMANPREET SINGH** *(Hockey)*
10.9 [4.5]

4 **D.K. GUKESH** *(Chess)*
8.7 [16.2]





5 **MANPREET SINGH** *(Hockey)*
6.0 [14.7]

Q. 3. Who do you think is India's No. 1 female sportsperson?



2 **MIRABAI CHANU** *(Weightlifting)*
11.5 [11.68]

3 **DIVYA DESHMUKH** *(Chess)*
8.6 [0.1]



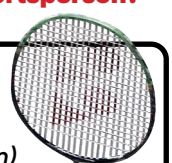


4 **MANU BHAKER** *(Shooting)*
8.4 [16.5]

5 **KONERU HUMPY** *(Chess)*
7.7 [0.6]



1 **P.V. SINDHU** *(Badminton)*
27.5
[22.6]





historic Test win against England at Lord's. In other sports, javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra, despite having a mediocre season by his lofty standards, continues his dominance as the No. 1 male sportsperson, with retired footballer Sunil Chhetri still in second and hockey captain Harmanpreet Singh finishing third. Chess world champion D. Gukesh's recent poor run on the board sees him drop one spot to No. 4.

The biggest surprise in the MOTN ranking for female sportspersons comes with 20-year-old grandmaster Divya Deshmukh, last year's World Cup winner and the most followed female chess player on Instagram, coming third behind the perennial No. 1 and No. 2—Olympic medalists P.V. Sindhu and Mirabai Chanu, respectively. In a sign that there's more to Indian sport than cricket, MOTN respondents acknowledge other athletes too, as shooter Esha Singh and compound archer Jyothi Surekha feature in the poll. ■